

What's your favorite productivity or personal development book?

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 05, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/4YYpqWchp1I> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

A short street-poll video pitting popular productivity and personal development books against each other in a bracket format. "Relentless" by Tim Grover ultimately wins, with one passionate respondent revealing it's tattooed on his arm.

Contents

-  The Book Bracket — Round by Round Voting
-  The Winner: Relentless
-  Why Relentless? The Tattooed Fan Explains

The Book Bracket — Round by Round Voting 0:00

- The host presents pairs (or lists) of books and asks passersby to pick their favorite
- Books presented in the early rounds include:
 - *Think and Grow Rich* vs. *As a Man Thinketh*
 - Crowd leans toward *Think and Grow Rich*
 - *Think and Grow Rich* vs. *The Power of Now*
 - *Think and Grow Rich* chosen
 - *Think and Grow Rich* vs. *Atomic Habits*
 - Crowd shifts to *Atomic Habits*
 - *Atomic Habits* vs. *Can't Hurt Me*
 - *Atomic Habits* holds on
 - *Atomic Habits* vs. *The 10X Rule*
 - *Atomic Habits* wins
 - *Atomic Habits* vs. *The Magic of Thinking Big*
 - *Atomic Habits* continues to win
- Later rounds introduce stoic and discipline-focused titles:
 - *Atomic Habits* vs. *The Obstacle Is the Way*

- *The Obstacle Is the Way* takes over as crowd favorite
- *The Obstacle Is the Way* vs. *Discipline Equals Freedom*
 - *The Obstacle Is the Way* wins
- *The Obstacle Is the Way* vs. *The Slight Edge*
 - *The Obstacle Is the Way* wins
- *The Obstacle Is the Way* vs. *The Daily Stoic*
 - *The Obstacle Is the Way* wins
- *The Obstacle Is the Way* vs. *Ego Is the Enemy*
 - *The Obstacle Is the Way* wins
- Power and mastery titles enter:
 - *The Obstacle Is the Way* vs. *40/48 Laws of Power*
 - *48 Laws of Power* wins (note: host initially says "40 laws," respondents correct to "48")
 - *48 Laws of Power* vs. *The Four Agreements*
 - *48 Laws of Power* wins
 - *48 Laws of Power* vs. *Make Your Bed*
 - *48 Laws of Power* wins
 - *48 Laws of Power* vs. *Relentless*
 - **Relentless** wins
 - *Relentless* vs. *Winning*
 - *Relentless* wins
 - *Relentless* vs. *Mastery*
 - *Relentless* wins

The Winner: Relentless 1:07

- *Relentless* by Tim Grover emerges as the overall crowd favorite after defeating every other title presented
- It beats out widely popular books including *Atomic Habits*, *48 Laws of Power*, *The Obstacle Is the Way*, and *Mastery*

Why Relentless? The Tattooed Fan Explains 1:07

- One respondent is asked directly: "Is that your favorite productivity book?"
 - He confirms: "It's my favorite book. I have it tattooed on my arm."
- Reason given for the deep connection:
 - "When I read this book, it just had a real impact on me on what it takes to get serious success."
 - "I try to abide by those principles."

- The host asks if he has actually read all the books presented in the bracket
 - He confirms: "Yeah, I read all those books."
- The exchange underscores *Relentless* as more than a popular pick — for at least one viewer, it is a lived philosophy